European Commission

CARBON BORDER ADJUSTMENT MECHANISM: HOW CBAM CERTIFICATES WORK

#CBAM

Starting in 2027, **CBAM importers must submit their annual CBAM declaration by 30 September for imports of CBAM goods during the preceding year**.

The CBAM declaration reports the quantity of goods imported, their embedded emissions, and the corresponding number of certificates.

Following declaration submission, the final step in the CBAM compliance process is to **surrender CBAM certificates by the same deadline**.

Managing your CBAM certificates is a cycle that starts well before this annual obligation. The flowchart below summarises the **key steps of the certificate process carried out through the CBAM Registry**.

STEP 1. Quarterly purchases*

Buy and hold CBAM certificates to comply with your quarterly obligation: At the end of each quarter, you must hold certificates corresponding to at least 50% of embedded emissions in all CBAM goods you have imported since the start of the year.

STEP 2. Annual surrender

By 30 September of the following year, **submit** your annual CBAM declaration and **surrender** the required CBAM certificates.

STEP 3. Excess certificates (optional)

If you have excess CBAM certificates on your CBAM account after the annual surrender...

3a. Repurchase**

Until 31 October, you can request a buy-back up to the number of CBAM certificates you had to buy to meet your quarterly obligation (see Step 1).

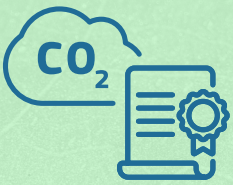
3b. Cancellation

On 1 November, two years after their purchase, **the Commission cancels excess CBAM certificates** that have not been repurchased and have expired. The buy-back option is no longer possible.

* ***No quarterly obligation in 2026***. *CBAM certificates are scheduled to go on sale on 1 February 2027. For 2026 embedded emissions, declarants must purchase all CBAM certificates required between 1 February and 30 September 2027.*

** ***2026 certificates can only be repurchased in 2027.*** *On 1 November 2027, the Commission will cancel excess CBAM certificates purchased for 2026 embedded emissions.*

CERTIFICATES CALCULATION



1 tonne of CO_2 equivalent
= 1 certificate*

CBAM CERTIFICATES AT A GLANCE



CBAM Registry

Purchase, hold, and surrender certificates through the CBAM Registry as of 1 February 2027.



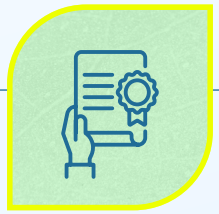
Pricing

The quarterly (for 2026) and weekly (for 2027 onwards) price is available on the official **CBAM Certificate Price page** and in the **CBAM Registry**.



Purchase by

the end of each quarter every year.



Surrender by

30 September of the following year, after annual declaration submission.



Repurchase by

31 October, after declaration submission and certificate surrender.

FOR MORE CBAM RESOURCES,

VISIT THE CBAM COMMUNICATION AND FAQS PAGE.

* ***Note:*** *To determine the final number of certificates to purchase, deduct — where applicable — the* ***free allocation adjustment*** *and the* ***carbon price paid in a third country****.*

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